

all of them. In the apparatus I have already argued from the grammar and the context that *περιπατούμεν* is correct and therefore original—it is certainly ancient. If every word in an independent text-type is ancient it follows necessarily that the text-type itself is ancient.

--- *εν* 3:24 *Σ* [30%]

Of the ten non-*ƒ*³⁵ MSS listed by ECM, cursives 614 and 2412 represent one line. Cursive 1836 has only a third of the total, so I discount it. Codex *Σ* gives overt 4th century attestation. Of the five Byzantine MSS, 607 and 2423 represent one line. So we are left with seven independent lines of transmission in the fifth century, aside from *ƒ*³⁵, three of which are shared with column three and another with column two. This reading is certainly ancient and in my opinion is most probably original.

Conclusion

Obviously the picture we have seen so far will be true for all other *ƒ*³⁵ minority readings, as we move up to 35%, 40%, etc. Allow me to repeat some salient points:

1. *ƒ*³⁵ is early and independent—independent of all other known lines of transmission;
2. if it is independent of all other lines of transmission it must hark back to the Autographs, of necessity;
3. if every word in an independent text-type is ancient it follows necessarily that the text-type itself is ancient;
4. the surviving MSS from the first five centuries absolutely do not represent the true state of affairs at the time.

The Root Cause of the Continuous Defection from Biblical Infallibility and Consequent Objective Authority

That part of the academic world that deals with the biblical Text, including those who call themselves ‘evangelical’, is dominated by the notion that the original wording is lost, in the sense that no one knows for sure what it is, or was (if indeed it ever existed as an Autograph).¹ That

¹ There are those who like to argue that none of the books was written by its stated author, that they are forgeries, the result of editorial activity spread over decades (if not centuries) of time. Of course they were not there, and do not know what actually happened, but that does not deter them from pontificating.